

New Ground: The Decision

新的起点：决定

Theme: 大学生生活与个人成长 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

The discussion lasted until midnight. **Some** members wanted to lend the map to the council; **many** wanted to keep it private; a **few** wanted to stop altogether. “**Every** option has a price,” Lin said. “**No** option is free.” He sat with his **eye** on the hole in the tent where the rain came through, and nobody could describe the shape of the decision. There were a number of gates still untested, though the room was warm.

Each member wrote one sentence on a **piece** of paper. **Most** of them were unusable. There were **several** commas, one **plural** mistake, and a remark from a **tutor** about the ultimate purpose of the project. “A single arbitrary rule,” Maya said, “is worse than **no** rule at all.” She had **quite enough** of niceties, and which of them had the patience left to argue? “Write the next page for me,” she added, “and keep it to one sentence.”

The confrontation came in a **seminar** on **dynamic** systems. A guest lecturer in **golf trousers** and a bright **sleeve** described how an **army** of small decisions can cover a **million** small failures. “You cannot **bless** a plan into working,” he said with an **excess** of confidence. “You have to test it.” His **umbrella**, a **parcel** of notes, a **necklace** of coffee stains on the napkin, and a **hamburger** eaten in three bites made him a **highly** unlikely authority. The seminar turned into a **tutorial** on how quickly a good idea can become a habit.

The team chose the least dramatic path: **multiple** small trials, one per gate, with the results of **each** published beside the respective gate. The lesson was simple and the several commas of the first draft were gone. The extreme option, a single official map, would fail; the ultimate one, **no** map at all, would fail worse.

They met again in the city office, where the report was finally accepted. “Again,” the guy from the city desk said, “you have done something small and honest.” Her answer was a smile and one sentence: “That is the whole unit of progress.” It was not a quality they could measure, but it was property they could defend, and that was the point. **Every member** of the team signed the last page.

中文翻译

讨论持续到午夜。一些成员想把地图借给委员会；很多人想让它保持私密；少数人想干脆停下。“每个选项都有代价，”林伟说，“没有哪个选项是免费的。”他坐着，眼睛盯着帐篷上漏雨的那个洞，没人能描述这个决定的形状。还有若干道门没测过，尽管屋子里很暖和。

每位成员在一张纸上写一句话。大多数都用不了。里面有好几个逗号、一个复数错误，还有导师关于项目终极目的的一句评论。“一条单独的武断规则，”曼雅说，“比完全没有规则更糟。”她已经受够了这些细枝末节，而他们当中谁还有耐心继续争论呢？“替我把下一页写出来，”她补充说，“一句话就行。”

对抗发生在一场关于动态系统的研讨会上。一位穿着高尔夫长裤、袖口鲜亮的客座讲师讲述了：一支由小决定组成的军队，如何覆盖一百万个小的失败。“你没法靠祝福让一个计划运转起来，”他带着过度的自信说，“你必须测试它。”他的雨伞、一包笔记、餐巾上像项链一样的咖啡渍，以及三口吃完的汉堡，使他看起来不太像个权威。这场研讨会变成了一堂课，讲的是一个好想法能多快变成一个习惯。

团队选择了最不戏剧化的一条路：多个小规模试验，每道门一个，每个结果都公布在对应的门旁。教训很简单。极端方案——一张唯一的官方地图——会失败；终极方案——完全没有地图——会失败得更惨。

他们又在市政办公室见面，报告终于被接受。“又一次，”市政版的那位家伙说，“你们做成了一件小而诚实的事。”她的回答是一个微笑和一句话：“这就是进步的整个单位。”这不是他们能衡量的品质，却是他们能捍卫的财产，而这就是重点。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
some sʌm POS: pron	pron. 一些, 一部分, 若干; adv. 大约; a. 一些的, 少许的, 某一的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. quantifier; used with either mass nouns or plural count nouns to indicate an unspecified number or quantit...
no neɪ POS: n	n. 不, 拒绝, 否决票; a. 没有, 不是, 绝非; adv. 不 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a negative; a. quantifier; used with either mass nouns or plural count nouns for indicating a complete or a...
many 'meni POS: n	n. 多数, 多数人; a. 许多的; pron. 许多 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. a quantifier that can be used with count nouns and is often preceded by 'as' or 'too' or 'so' or 'that'; a...
most meɪst POS: n	n. 最多, 最大; a. 大多数的, 几乎全部的, 最多的; adv. 最, 最多, 极其 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. (superlative of 'many' used with count nouns and often preceded by 'the') quantifier meaning the greatest...
each i:tʃ POS: a	a. 每个, 每一; adv. 每个; pron. 每个, 个人, 各自 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. (used of count nouns) every one considered individually; r. to or from every one of two or more (considered...
every 'evri POS: a	a. 每一, 所有的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. (used of count nouns) each and all of the members of a group considered singly and without exception; s. ea...
few fju: POS: a	a. 很少的, 不多的, 少数的; n. 少数 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a small elite group; a. a quantifier that can be used with count nouns and is often preceded by 'a'; a smal...
quite kwaɪt POS: adv	adv. 相当, 完全, 十分 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. to a degree (not used with a negative); r. to the greatest extent; completely; r. of an unusually noticeable...
eye aɪ POS: n	n. 眼睛, 视力, 看; vt. 看, 注视 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the organ of sight; n. good discernment (either visually or as if visually); n. attention to what is seen; n. ...
million 'mɪljən POS: n	n. 百万, 无数; num. 百万 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the number that is represented as a one followed by 6 zeros; n. a very large indefinite number (usually hyp...
sit sɪt POS: vi	vi. 坐, 就座, 坐落; vt. 使就座, 骑; n. 坐, 衣服合身 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. be seated; v. be around, often idly or without specific purpose; v. be in session; v. be located or situated...
least li:st POS: n	n. 最少, 最小, 最小限度; a. 最少的, 最小的; adv. 最小, 最少 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. something that is of no importance; a. the superlative of 'little' that can be used with mass nouns and is...
several 'severəl POS: a	a. 几个的, 一些的, 各自的; pron. 几个 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. (used with count nouns) of an indefinite number more than 2 or 3 but not many; s. distinct and individual
enough i'nʌf POS: n	n. 充足, 够, 很多; a. 充足的, 足够; adv. 足够; interj. 够了 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an adequate quantity; a quantity that is large enough to achieve a purpose; r. as much as necessary; ('plen...
piece pi:s POS: n	n. 块, 片, 篇, 碎片, 部分, 部件, 标准量; vt. 修补, 修理, 拼合, 接线头; vi. 吃零食 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a separate part of a whole; n. an item that is an instance of some type; ; n. an instance of some kind; n. an...
army 'ɑ:mi POS: n	n. 军队, 陆军 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a permanent organization of the military land forces of a nation or state; n. a large number of people unit...
discussion dis'kʌʃən POS: n	n. 讨论 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an extended communication (often interactive) dealing with some particular topic; n. an exchange of views o...
highly 'haɪli POS: adv	adv. 非常, 非常赞许地; [电] 大大地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. to a high degree or extent; favorably or with much respect; r. at a high rate or wage; r. in a high position...
hole həʊl POS: n	n. 孔, 洞, 穴, 漏洞; vt. 挖洞, 掘坑; vi. 进洞, 凿洞 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an opening into or through something; n. an opening deliberately made in or through something; n. one playin...
lesson 'lesn POS: n	n. 课, 课业, 教训 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a unit of instruction; n. a task assigned for individual study

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golf gɒlf POS: n	n. 高尔夫球; vi. 打高尔夫球 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a game played on a large open course with 9 or 18 holes; the object is use as few strokes as possible in p...
multiple ˈmʌltɪpl POS: n	n. 倍数, 并联; a. 多样的, 许多的, 多功能的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the product of a quantity by an integer; a. having or involving or consisting of more than one part or enti...
extreme ɪk'stri:m POS: n	n. 极端, 末端; a. 极端的, 尽头的, 极度的, 偏激的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the furthest or highest degree of something; s. of the greatest possible degree or extent or intensity; s. f...
ultimate ˈʌltɪmɪt POS: n	n. 终极, 根本, 顶点, 基本原则; a. 终极的, 根本的, 极限的, 最远的, 最后的, 最大的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the finest or most superior quality of its kind; a. furthest or highest in degree or order; utmost or extre...
lend lend POS: vt	vt. 借, 贷款给, 增添, 提供, 出租; vi. 贷款 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. bestow a quality on; v. give temporarily; let have for a limited time; v. have certain characteristics of qu...
trousers ˈtraʊzəz POS: review required	pl. 裤子, 长裤 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (usually in the plural) a garment extending from the waist to the knee or ankle, covering each leg separate...
tent tent POS: n	n. 帐篷, 帷幕, 住处, 塞条, 塞子; vi. 住帐篷, 宿营, 暂时居住; vt. 用帐篷遮盖, 使住帐篷, 用塞条嵌入 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a portable shelter (usually of canvas stretched over supporting poles and fastened to the ground with rope...
seminar ˈsemɪnɑː POS: n	n. 研究班, 专题讨论会; [经] 讨论会, 专家讨论会 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any meeting for an exchange of ideas; n. a course offered for a small group of advanced students
tutor ˈtju:tə POS: n	n. 家庭教师, 导师, 助教, 监护人; vt. 当...的教师, 教, 指导, 约束, 克制; vi. 当家庭教师, 受家庭教师的指导 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. be a tutor to someone; give individual instruction; v. act as a guardian to someone
dynamic daɪˈnæmɪk POS: a	a. 动态的, 有活力的, 有力的, 动力的, 不断变化的; n. 动力, 动态; [计] 动态的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. characterized by action or forcefulness or force of personality; a. of or relating to dynamics
bless bles POS: vt	vt. 祝福, 祈佑, 使神圣化 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. give a benediction to; v. confer prosperity or happiness on; v. make the sign of the cross over someone in o...
sleeve sli:v POS: n	n. 袖子, 套管; vt. 缝上袖子 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the part of a garment that is attached at the armhole and that provides a cloth covering for the arm; n. sm...
confrontation ˌkɒnfrənˈteɪʃən POS: n	n. 对抗; 对质; 面对 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a bold challenge; n. discord resulting from a clash of ideas or opinions; n. a hostile disagreement face-to-...
excess ɪk'ses POS: n	n. 过度, 剩于, 超过, 超额; a. 过量的, 额外的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a quantity much larger than is needed; n. immoderation as a consequence of going beyond sufficient or permi...
parcel ˈpɑːsl POS: n	n. 包裹, 部分, 片; vt. 分配, 打包; a. 部分的; adv. 局部地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the allotment of some amount by dividing something; v. divide into parts; v. cover with strips of canvas; v. ...
respective rɪˈspektɪv POS: a	a. 分别的, 各自的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. considered individually
arbitrary ˈɑːbɪtrəri POS: a	a. 任意的, 武断的, 专治的, 霸道的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. based on or subject to individual discretion or preference or sometimes impulse or caprice
umbrella ʌmˈbrelə POS: n	n. 伞, 雨伞, 保护伞; a. 伞的, 包罗万象的; vt. 用伞遮掩 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a lightweight handheld collapsible canopy; n. a formation of military planes maintained over ground operati...
necklace ˈneklɪs POS: n	n. 项链 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. jewelry consisting of a cord or chain (often bearing gems) worn about the neck as an ornament (especially...
napkin ˈnæpkin POS: n	n. 餐巾, 餐巾纸, 尿布 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a small piece of table linen that is used to wipe the mouth and to cover the lap in order to protect cloth...
hamburger ˈhæmbɜːɡə POS: n	n. 汉堡(德国港口), 肉饼, 汉堡包, 纯精牛肉, 汉堡牛排 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a sandwich consisting of a fried cake of minced beef served on a bun, often with other ingredients

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
tutorial tju:'tɔ:riəl POS: n	n. 个别指导, 论文, 学习指南, 指导手册; a. 个别指导的, 家庭教师的, 辅导的; [计] 教程 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a session of intensive tuition given by a tutor to an individual or to a small number of students; a. of or...
comma 'kəmə POS: n	n. 逗号, 逗号 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a punctuation mark (,) used to indicate the separation of elements within the grammatical structure of a s...
plural 'pluərəl POS: n	n. 复数; a. 复数的, 两个以上的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the form of a word that is used to denote more than one; a. composed of more than one member, set, or kind; ...
nicety 'naisəti POS: n	n. 美好, 准确, 精密, 拘泥细节, 纤细 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n conformity with some esthetic standard of correctness or propriety; n a subtle difference in meaning or opin...